

Bitlocker encrypts the data on disk, so even if someone rips out your hard drive and uses Linux or some other OS or tool that bypasses Windows permissions, all they will get is encrypted data that is useless without a key.

Hyper-V

If you tend to play around with virtual machines a lot, you'll probably find Hyper-V quite useful. It is Microsoft's software for running virtual machines, and supports not only Windows but also Linux guests.

You can always install VirtualBox or VMWare Player on Windows 10 Home, and for many people that might be the better and cheaper option. However, Hyper-V is more comparable to professional virtualization solutions like VMware Workstation. It has some advanced features that you will find lacking in the free alternatives.

Unfortunately, Hyper-V cannot coexist with VMWare Player / Workstation or Oracle VirtualBox, so if you need to use any of those you can't use Hyper-V.



If you tend to emulate Windows on a virtual machine, Hyper-V will probably be a better option than VMWare Player or Oracle VirtualBox.

Current branch for business

As we explained before, Windows 10 now has multiple branches or tracks or channels for delivering updates. The fastest update track is if you opt into Microsoft's Insider track which gives you beta builds, and then choose the 'Fast' option. Slower than that is the 'Slow' option of the Insider track.

What most people will be using, and what Home users will be forced to use is the Current Branch. This will be updated with new builds every few months, requiring Home users to upgrade.

Pro users can delay upgrades and move to what Microsoft calls the 'Current Branch for Business'. This doesn't delay upgrades forever, but simply delays upgrades till – in Microsoft's own words – 'their quality and application compatibility has been assessed in the consumer market'. In other words, after Home users have served as involuntary testers for Microsoft's new builds.